

MSI Megabook M660	Sony VAIO AR18GP	Toshiba Qosimo F20
Core Duo T2300/1.66 Intel 945GM DDR2/533MHz/512MB	Core Duo T2600/2.16 Intel 945PM DDR2/533MHz/1GB	Pentium M 750/1.86 Intel 915PM DDR2/533MHz/512MB
Integrated Intel 82945GM/128MB	Dedicated GeForce Go 7600GT/256MB	Dedicated GeForce Go 6600/128MB
15.4 Wide/1280x800	17 Wide/1920x1200	15.4 Wide/1280x800
60 GB, 4200 rpm Combo drive	160 GB (Raid 0), 5400 rpm Blue-ray writer	80 GB, 5400 rpm DVD-Writer
4/1 Type II	3/0 Express	3/1 Type II
✗/a,b,g / ✗/Gigabit	✗/a,b,g / ✓/10/100	✗/b,g / ✗/10/100
✓/✓	✗/✗	✓/✓
MMC, SD, MS/Pro 1.3 MP camera	SD, MS/Pro/Duo Wi-Fi switch, media buttons, and 1.3MP camera	SD, MS, XD TV-Tuner, Wi-Fi switch, AV out, and media buttons
35.5 x 25.5 x 3.5 2.5 3.63 3	41.6 x 29.95 x 3.35 3.8 4 3.5	37 x 27 x 5 4.5 3.5 3
Windows XP Pro SP2 ✓ ✗ ✗	Windows XP Pro SP2 ✗ NIS and Ulead DiscRecorder ✗	Windows XP Home SP2 ✓ NAV 2005 ✗
19.8 142	27.8 112	16.2 285
11396/8404 26095/35545 3167/3164 22/13 42/41	14730/10860 33738/45913 3952/3959 56/20 297.1/295.7	6078/4537 17370/19638 2519/2536 32/10 128.4/126.5
4800/3284 738/2148 4261	6220/4073 6417/4607 6008	3650/3380 2801/3255 3711
3.9 160 2:05	4.8 160 2:04	4.1 160 2:25
19.69 35.12 8.60 63.42 62,000	20.70 51.91 2.67 75.27 1,99,900	19.48 32.63 6.28 58.38 84,990



+ Looks great
- Needs more RAM



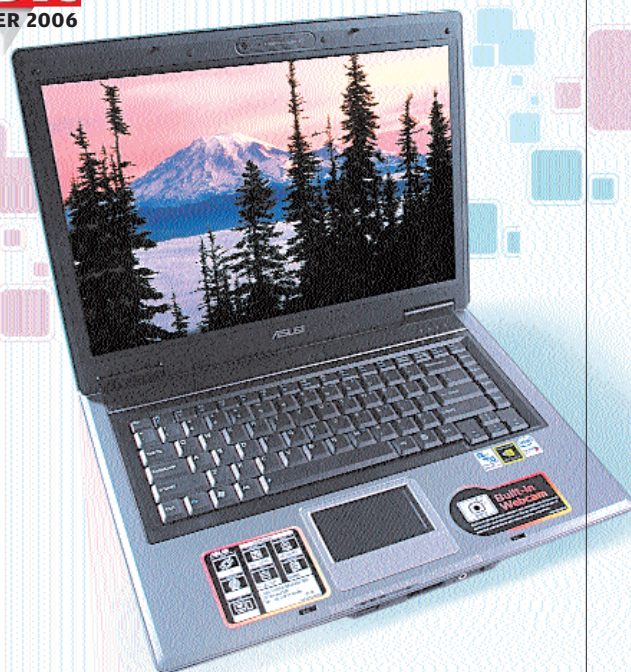
+ RAID 0
- Very expensive!



+ TV-Tuner
- Slower CPU

seconds. Both these laptops are excellent for audio/video encoding.

PC Mark gives you the scores of individual sub-systems like the CPU, graphics, memory, and hard disk. The quality and performance of these sub-systems is reflected in the overall scores. The VAIO AR18GP left the competition biting the dust with an overall score of 6008 units in PC Mark 2004, while the Asus F3JM was close, with a score of 5924 units. What's interesting is that the hard drive score: the Sony laptop returned nearly 1000 points more than the rest. The RAID config-



ASUS F3JM—A Desktop basher

uration is indeed working in Sony's favour.

The HP Pavilion dv8216TX has a battery life of 160 minutes. This is great taking into consideration the screen size and high-volume speakers on the unit. The Sony VAIO AR18GP lasted for 124 minutes on the battery. This figures are a clear indicator that these powerful machines are not as power-hungry as we thought.

Our Conclusion

Sony's AR18GP was the winner because of its blazing performance and future-proof features like the HD-capable screen and the Blu-Ray disc drive. Priced at Rs 1,99,900, Sony does expect you to pay for the performance and features on offer. Raw performance has always demanded atrocious prices, but it never came bundled in such a beautiful-looking machine.

The ASUS F3JM came in second thanks to its superb overall performance and a configuration that would put a regular Desktop to shame. The sensible pricing ensured a secure place on the podium. The Dell Latitude D820 was as impressive as the Sony VAIO or the ASUS F3JM, but the pricing left it a bit behind the ASUS. ■

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